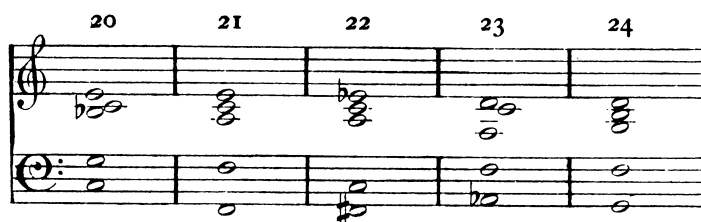


PRELUDE I

THE bar added by Schwenke between bars 22 and 23 shows the danger of misunderstanding one of Bach's most characteristic progressions, the skip in the bass from F# to A♭, avoiding striking the dominant until the long pedal-point begins. Probably Schwenke thought it desirable to have an even number of bars before reaching this point; this is, however, not necessary. But Schwenke (unlike Gounod and other moderns) did not misconstrue the harmony of bar 23, in which it is not the middle C which is unessential, but the B. The sense of bars 20 to 24 is as follows:



and this may be suggested, either by playing bar 23 almost as a melody with practically no pedal (which method presupposes that the whole piece has been played *spianato*—i.e., with thread-like clearness and no *sostenuto* in the right hand), or, perhaps better, with the following

touch:  , which presupposes plenty of pedal elsewhere, and

some care to prevent the B from remaining in the chord here. In either case such harmonic subtleties cannot be expressed with a heavy touch or in a quick *tempo*. The climax is obviously attained at bar 29, and the dying away after it is equally obvious, especially with the B♭ of bar 32 followed by the relaxing of the rhythm in the last three bars.

FUGUE I

A *STRETTO* Fugue, occupied entirely with the entries of the Subject. From bar 14 onwards these overlap (or at least join) twelve times. In the course of such a passage even the most fragmentary hint of the Subject (such as the F#, G#, A of the alto in bar 16) should so be played as to contribute to the cumulative effect. Mark particularly the bass entry arising from the crotchet in the middle of bar 17, and bring out also the distorted version in the bass in bars 20½-21. This was less liable to be overlooked in Bach's earliest versions of this Fugue, since its group of  (instead of ) represents the theme as Bach first wrote it throughout. By dotting this group in the Subject he improved the counterpoint everywhere, but here and there found some difficulty in deciding a resultant detail; notably in bar 9, where (as, for a different reason, in bar 4) we adopt the reading of an important early copy which, while not always trustworthy, has here no likely reason for going wrong.

The rest of the counterpoint is all derived from the semiquaver figure of bar 2, often treated by inversion (as in bar 4).

The *tempo* is a flowing eight or (rather) a slow four in the bar; and the prevalent touch a *legato cantabile* in all the parts. The "false relations" in bars 13 and 18 make excellent sense if in the upper parts the second quaver is attacked as a fresh phrase-entry, while the lower parts remain unbroken in their flow. The shake given in brackets in bar 13 may always be understood in such cadences. It begins with the upper note, stops on the dot, and is practically identical with the ornament given by some good MSS. in bar 19.

A.B. 99.